

Butter Vox

Vocal Chain + Melting Echo

User Manual | Version 1.0 | macOS (Audio Unit, VST3, Standalone)

Welcome to Butter Vox

Butter Vox is a complete vocal chain in one window. It cleans, compresses, warms and brightens a voice, then adds a modulated stereo echo and a melting reverb with a glittering shimmer. Every control is a vertical slider, grouped into colour-coded sections so you can read the whole chain at a glance.

The plug-in is built for lead vocals, ad-libs, loop-station layers and spoken word. Twenty recipe presets cover jazz, soul, hip-hop, trap, afrobeats and ambient sounds, and every preset is a starting point you can reshape.

Highlights

- **One slab of butter, six sections:** Input + Clean, Squash, Toast, Echo, Melt and Output.
- **Hybrid echo:** free time, tempo sync or tap tempo, ping-pong spread, filters inside the feedback loop and tape-style modulation.
- **Glitter:** an octave-up shimmer that sparkles inside the Melt reverb.
- **Resizable and sharp:** drag the bottom-right corner to scale the interface from half size to double size.
- **Tooltips everywhere:** hover any control for a plain-language explanation.
- **Live meter:** the vintage VU meter follows your output level.
- **20 presets** reachable from the preset menu, the arrow buttons or your DAW's own preset list.

Interface map



The picture above shows the interface. Sections run left to right in signal order. The Echo section carries the display, the Sync switch, the note-length menu and the TAP button.

Installation (macOS)

System requirements: macOS 11 or later, Apple Silicon or Intel (universal build). A host that supports Audio Unit or VST3 plug-ins, such as Logic Pro, GarageBand, Ableton Live, Reaper or Studio One. Butter Vox is a stereo plug-in.

Using the installer

- Open **ButterVox-1.0.0.dmg** and double-click **ButterVox-1.0.0.pkg**.
- Follow the prompts. Enter your Mac password when asked.
- The installer places the files shown in the table below.
- Restart your DAW. Logic Pro scans new Audio Units automatically on launch.

File	Location
Butter Vox.component (Audio Unit)	/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components
Butter Vox.vst3	/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3
Butter Vox.app (Standalone)	/Applications
This manual (PDF)	/Library/Application Support/Butter Vox

First launch and Gatekeeper

Builds that are not notarized by Apple show a warning the first time. Control-click (or right-click) the installer, choose Open, then confirm. If macOS still blocks a plug-in, open System Settings, Privacy and Security, and choose Open Anyway next to the Butter Vox message.

Using Butter Vox in your DAW

- **Logic Pro:** add an Audio FX slot, choose Audio Units, then Butter Vox Audio, then Butter Vox. If it does not appear, open Logic Pro, Settings, Plug-in Manager and press Reset and Rescan Selection.
- **Ableton Live:** enable VST3 and Audio Units in Preferences, Plug-ins, then rescan.
- **Standalone app:** open Butter Vox from Applications, pick your audio interface in the settings button, and sing. Use headphones to avoid feedback.

Uninstalling

Delete the three items listed in the table above (the plug-in files and the app). No other files are installed.

Quick start

- **1. Pick a preset.** Use the menu at the top or the < and > buttons. Start with Soft Open or Velvet Hour.
- **2. Set Input.** Sing a loud phrase and lower Input until the signal stays comfortably away from clipping.
- **3. Shape the voice.** Raise Low Cut until the boom disappears, add De-Ess if S sounds sharp, then bring up Squash until the level feels steady.
- **4. Add colour.** A little Drive adds warmth. Air lifts the top end or softens a bright microphone.
- **5. Add space.** Turn Echo Mix up for repeats, Wet up for room and Glitter up for sparkle. Turn on Sync to lock the echo to your tempo.
- **6. Balance.** Use Mix to blend with the dry voice and Output to set the final level.

Handy tips

- Double-click any slider to return it to its default value.
- Click a value under a slider to type an exact number. Typing 2k sets 2 kHz.
- Hold Shift while dragging for fine control.
- Hover over any control for a tooltip.
- Resize the window by dragging the bottom-right corner.
- Double-click any knob or slider to reset it. Presets load instantly and are saved with your DAW project, along with any tweaks you made.

Signal flow



Dry input is tapped after the Input knob and blended back in by the Mix slider. The Melt reverb listens to the post-echo signal.

Processing runs in the order shown. Cleaning comes first so rumble and harsh sibilance never reach the compressor or the echo. The echo feeds the reverb, so every repeat pools into the room.

Control reference

INPUT + CLEAN

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Input	-24 to +12 dB	0 dB	Gain into the chain. Set it so peaks stay clear of clipping.
Low Cut	20 to 400 Hz	80 Hz	High-pass filter that removes rumble, plosives and proximity boom.
De-Ess	0 to 100%	30%	Reduces harsh S and T sounds above about 6.5 kHz.

SQUASH

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Squash	0 to 100%	40%	One-knob compressor. Higher settings lower the threshold, raise the ratio and add automatic makeup gain.
Attack	0.1 to 80 ms	8 ms	How quickly compression starts. Slower keeps more punch.
Release	20 to 800 ms	160 ms	How quickly compression lets go. Longer is smoother.

TOAST

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Drive	0 to 100%	15%	Warm saturation that adds harmonics and presence. Think light, golden, dark and burnt toast.
Air	-6 to +9 dB	+2 dB	High shelf at 9 kHz. Positive values add sparkle, negative values soften.

ECHO

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Time	20 to 1500 ms	320 ms	Delay time. Greyed out while Sync is on.
Feedback	0 to 95%	35%	Number of repeats. A safety limiter keeps high settings under control.
Hi Cut	1 to 20 kHz	6 kHz	Low-pass filter in the feedback loop. Each repeat grows darker.
Lo Cut	20 to 1000 Hz	150 Hz	High-pass filter in the feedback loop. Keeps repeats light and clear of the vocal.
Rate	0.05 to 8 Hz	0.6 Hz	Speed of the delay-time modulation.
Depth	0 to 100%	15%	Amount of modulation, up to plus or minus 8 ms. Opposite phase on left and right adds width.
Spread	0 to 100%	50%	Stereo ping-pong. At 100% the echoes alternate fully between left and right.
Echo Mix	0 to 100%	25%	Level of the echo added to the vocal.
Sync / Division	Off, 1/16 to 1/1	Off, 1/4	Locks the echo to the DAW tempo. T is triplet and D is dotted. Without tempo information the plug-in assumes 120 BPM.
TAP	n/a	n/a	Tap a few times to set the echo time. Sync switches off so your tapped time is heard.

MELT

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Size	0 to 100%	40%	Room size, from a small booth to a cathedral.
Damp	0 to 100%	50%	High-frequency absorption. Higher is darker.
Wet	0 to 100%	15%	Level of the Melt reverb.
Glitter	0 to 100%	0%	Octave-up shimmer inside the reverb. Raise it for sparkle and glassy glow.

OUTPUT

Control	Range	Default	What it does
Mix	0 to 100%	100%	Blend between the dry input and the full chain.
Output	-24 to +12 dB	0 dB	Final level.

Factory presets

Twenty presets ship with Butter Vox. Names in the Echo column show the tempo-synced note length where Sync is on.

#	Name	Echo	Character
1	**Soft Open**	320 ms	A clean, polished beginning with a whisper of echo and room.
2	**Velvet Hour**	1/8D	Smooth, close lead vocal with a dotted echo that lingers like a slow exhale.
3	**Close Talk**	110 ms	Short golden slapback that sounds like someone leaning in to speak at your ear.
4	**Slow Dance**	1/4	Quarter note echoes that sway from side to side.
5	**Candlelight**	520 ms	Big, warm bloom with slow repeats that glow and fade.
6	**Smoke and Satin**	1/8	Warm, wobbly tape echoes with a soft haze around the edges.
7	**Midnight Pulse**	1/8T	Tight, glossy triplet echoes with an urgent heartbeat.
8	**Hip Sway**	1/8D	Dotted eighth echoes that swing wide, made for afrobeats grooves.
9	**Amber Room**	180 ms	A warm, close room with a hint of grit, like a lit-low lounge.
10	**Last Call**	240 ms	Gentle compression, a dim room and a soft echo for late-set intimacy.
11	**Late Night Line**	150 ms	Narrow, crunchy phone-call tone, close and a little secretive.
12	**Slow Tide**	420 ms	Deep, rolling modulation with dark repeats that pull you under.
13	**Golden Hour**	1/4	Bright, forward and radiant with a clean quarter note echo.
14	**Breathless**	300 ms	Airy, shimmering top end for soft vocals right at the microphone.
15	**Cathedral Hush**	600 ms	A vast stone hall with slow echoes, spacious and reverent.
16	**Slow Burn**	1/4D	Long dotted quarter trails that build and smolder.
17	**Love Letter Tape**	330 ms	Dusty, saturated cassette warmth, like a mixtape made by hand.
18	**Pillow Talk**	1/8	Wide eighth note throws that whisper across the stereo field.
19	**Champagne Shimmer**	350 ms	Glittering, glassy modulation with a bright, effervescent reverb.
20	**Satin Choir**	480 ms	Layered, swirling stereo repeats that sound like a velvet choir.

Recipes and tips

Lead vocal polish

Start with Velvet Hour. Set Low Cut near 90 Hz, De-Ess to taste, Squash around 50% and a little Drive. Keep Echo Mix under 25% so words stay clear.

Loop-station layers

Use Spread near 100% on background layers and a lower Mix on the lead. Layer presets such as Satin Choir and Candlelight turn simple loops into stacked harmonies.

Making echoes sit behind the voice

Raise Lo Cut and lower Hi Cut in the Echo section. Thinner, darker repeats leave room for the lead vocal.

Ad-libs and throws

Use Pillow Talk or Slow Burn, then automate Echo Mix in your DAW so only the last word of a phrase repeats.

Tape feel

Combine Drive at 40 to 50%, Depth at 30 to 40% and Hi Cut near 3.5 kHz.

Gain staging

Squash adds automatic makeup gain. Check the level after changing it and use Output to match the bypassed level for fair comparisons.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Plug-in missing in Logic Pro	Restart Logic Pro, then use Settings, Plug-in Manager, Reset and Rescan Selection. Confirm Butter Vox.component sits in /Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components.
Plug-in missing in another DAW	Enable VST3 scanning in the DAW preferences and rescan.
macOS blocks the installer	Control-click the installer, choose Open, or use Open Anyway in Privacy and Security.
Echo timing drifts from the beat	Turn Sync on and make sure the DAW project tempo is set. Hosts that share no tempo give 120 BPM.
Feedback squeal in Standalone	Use headphones or lower the input level. Mute the monitor speakers.
Mono track	Butter Vox is a stereo plug-in. Place it on a stereo track or an aux send. Most hosts upmix a mono track automatically.

Technical specifications

Item	Detail
Formats	Audio Unit (effect), VST3, Standalone app

Item	Detail
Architecture	Universal (arm64 and x86_64), macOS 11 or later
Channels	Stereo in, stereo out
Latency	0 samples
Maximum echo time	2.9 seconds (tempo-synced times are clamped to this)
Reverb tail	Reported to the host as 6 seconds
Interface size	600 x 240 up to 2400 x 960 points, fixed aspect ratio
Presets	20 factory presets, host program list supported

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